

Am I ready for a pet?

Work through this with your head — and your heart. Tick each box you can honestly check.



Financial readiness

- ☐ I can comfortably cover year-one costs (\$1,900–\$5,800 by breed) without financial stress
- ☐ I've budgeted for ongoing annual costs — about \$1,500–\$3,200/yr (dog) or \$1,200–\$2,000/yr (cat)
- ☐ I have, or will get, pet insurance before bringing my pet home
- ☐ I have an emergency vet fund of at least \$1,500 set aside
- ☐ I've researched vet costs in my area — prices vary a lot by city
- ☐ I've budgeted for boarding or pet-sitting when I travel

Lifestyle & home

- ☐ My home is suitable — enough space, outdoor access, and rental rules allow pets
- ☐ Everyone in my household is genuinely on board (including any existing pets)
- ☐ I have enough time daily — dogs need 2+ hours of exercise and attention
- ☐ I've researched the breed's energy level, temperament and grooming needs
- ☐ I've planned for what happens if I need to travel for work or holidays

Long-term commitment

- ☐ I'm prepared for a 10–15 year commitment, through life changes
- ☐ I've thought about what happens if I move, have children or change jobs
- ☐ I've researched breed-specific health issues for the breed I'm considering
- ☐ I'm choosing a pet because I want to care for an animal — not just because they're cute
- ☐ I've considered adopting from a rescue centre as my first option

How did you do?

Most boxes ticked? You're in a strong position — welcome that new family member with confidence. A few gaps? No rush. Close them first, and you'll enjoy every moment without the financial worry.

Ready to see your pet's real numbers?

Get a personalised estimate in under 2 minutes — choose your breed, petcost-calculator.com/calculator for a full breakdown.

